all really important civil cases also, are conducted before himself. He is easily excited to anger, but soon cools down again. By nature moreover he is kindly and benevolent and is sincerely anxious that guilt should be punished, without malice indeed, but at the same time without undue leniency. Hence in cases in which he himself acts as judge the guilty are, by his own directions, not punished until he has given orders for the third time that this shall be done.'

From Delhi, the camp set out in a northerly direction, towards the low mountains and the foothills, so as to always be close to a water source for the needs of the gigantic army. Sappers were sent ahead to level the roads over 'rocks and crags and deep torrent-beds' under the charge of Akbar's best military engineer, Muhammad Qasim Mir Barr.

Two days after leaving Delhi, the caravan reached Sonepat, more 'famous than many a city on account of the swords, scimitars, daggers, poniards, and steel points for spears, pikes and javelins, which are skilfully manufactured here and exported to all parts of the empire'. Iron and steel were mined from the lower reaches of the Himalayas and brought to the town, which was populated by many weapons manufacturers for this very reason.

In Panipat, 'the inhabitants, especially the women, filled the balconies and the roofs in their eagerness to see the King', who must have cut a very dashing figure on his fine horse, surrounded by all his noblemen. But the king was not his usual affable self during the early part of this journey. Seemingly oppressed by Mirza Hakim's challenge, he was seen frowning, and anxious, caught up in an internal turmoil that no one could distract him from.

Monserrate has left a somewhat damning description of Hindustani towns which, he wrote, were striking from afar but when inspected closely it was found that 'the narrowness, aimless crookedness, and ill-planning of the streets deprive these cities of all beauty'. However the wealthy inhabitants, he conceded, 'adorn the roofs and arched ceilings of their houses with carvings and paintings; plant ornamental gardens in their courtyards; make tanks and fish-ponds, which are lined with tiles of various colours; construct artificial springs and fountains, which fling showers of water far into the air; and lay down promenades paved with brickwork or marble'. At every halt multitudes gathered to meet the Padshah. They brought him gifts for vows fulfilled, asked him for spiritual advice, and